RESOLUTION NO. 16 - 2023

RESOLUTION TERMINATING THE STATE OF EMERGENCY IN SAN JUAN COUNTY AND TERMINATING MANDATORY COVID-19 VACCINATION FOR SAN JUAN COUNTY, WASHINGTON EMPLOYEES AND VOLUNTEERS

WHEREAS, on March 13, 2020, the County Council issued Resolution 08-2020, proclaiming a State of Emergency for San Juan County as a result of the COVID-19 outbreak; and

WHEREAS, the measures we have taken together since early 2020, including the vaccination of over 90 percent of San Juan County's adult population, have made a difference and altered the course of the pandemic in fundamental ways; and

WHEREAS, with San Juan County's high level of vaccination booster uptake, particularly among those considered to be the most at-risk, the number of hospitalizations has stabilized at a safe level; and

WHEREAS, while COVID-19 appears to be here to stay, recent advances in medicine, including the widespread availability of vaccines for adults and children, as well as treatments like antivirals, are reasons to be hopeful that we will have the tools to protect ourselves and communities from severe disease and death to the greatest extent possible; and

WHEREAS, Governor Jay Inslee terminated the COVID-19 State of Emergency proclaimed in Proclamation 20-05, and also rescinded all COVID-19 emergency proclamations issued pursuant to Proclamation 20-05, effective October 31, 2022; and

WHEREAS, World Health Organization announced an end to the global health emergency for COVID-19 on May 5, 2023; and

WHEREAS, the federal COVID-19 Public Health Emergency declaration ended on May 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, the Biden-Harris Administration lifted the COVID-19 vaccine requirements for Federal employees, Federal contractors and international air travelers on May 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, Governor Jay Inslee rescinded the COVID-19 vaccine requirements for State employees in Directive 22-13.1, effective May 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, the use of emergency powers are no longer needed to manage the risks of COVID-19 for the reasons set forth above;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the County Council of San Juan County, state of Washington, as follows:

1. The State of Emergency within San Juan County, Washington, declared in Resolution 08-2020 adopted March 13, 2020, is terminated.

2. The prohibitions and requirements of Resolution 23-2021 adopted August 24, 2021, Establishing Mandatory COVID-19 Vaccinations for San Juan County, Washington Employees and Volunteers, are terminated.

3. This Resolution is effective immediately.

ADOPTED this 22nd day of May 2023.

ATTEST: Clerk of the Council

Sally Rogers 5/22/2023
Sally Rogers, Clerk Date

COUNTY COUNCIL
SAN JUAN COUNTY, WASHINGTON

Cindy ~~Wolf~~, Chair
District 2

REVIEWED BY COUNTY MANAGER

5/22/23
Michael J. Thomas Date

J. D. Fuller 5/22/23
Jane Fuller, Vice-Chair
District 3

APPROVED AS TO FORM ONLY
AMY S. VIRA

By: 5/22/23
Date

Christine Minney
Christine Minney, Member
District 1